



5 Tips to Keep Your Old Photos Alive

A free guide from Dan · Photo Scanning Studio · Hamburg, NY

Hi, I'm Dan. I scan family photos for folks all over Western New York and beyond. The truth is, most photo damage happens slowly, in places you'd never suspect. Here are five things you can do this weekend to give your photos a much longer life — no special equipment needed.

1

Get them out of the basement, attic, and garage

Heat, humidity, and temperature swings cause photos to stick, curl, fade, and grow mold. Store them in a closet or under a bed inside the main living area instead.

2

Keep them out of direct sunlight

Sunlight fades photos a little every day, and it never stops. Move treasured originals into a closed album or box, and display a printed copy in the frame instead.

3

Handle them by the edges

Skin oils and fingerprints quietly damage photo emulsion over the years. Hold prints by the edges with clean, dry hands. A \$5 pair of cotton gloves makes a real difference for big stacks.

4

Get them out of magnetic albums

Those 70s and 80s sticky-page albums are slowly destroying the photos inside them. If yours are still removable, get them out now. If they're already stuck, don't force it.

5

Make a digital backup before something happens

Fires, floods, and basement leaks happen here in WNY every year. A digital copy is the only backup that survives a disaster, and it lets you share memories with family in one click.

Feeling overwhelmed by boxes of photos?

I scan everything personally, in my home studio in Hamburg, NY, and I treat your photos the way I'd treat my own family's. No pressure.

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— from Dan, Photo Scanning Studio